

Translation & Authentication Guide

Step-by-step guidance on when you need a certified translation, and which authentication method your destination expects.

When Translation Is Required

If your documents aren't in English (or your destination country's official language), you need certified translations alongside the originals.

Translation Requirements

- ☐ Done by a certified or sworn translator - not a friend or family member, however fluent
- ☐ Translator's credentials and official stamp included
- ☐ Both the original document and the translation submitted together
- ☐ Translation matches the original exactly - no summarizing or paraphrasing
- ☐ Translator's contact details provided for verification

Document Authentication Methods

Method	What it is	When required
Notarization	A notary public verifies your signature	Most common requirement across all destinations
Attestation	Government verification of documents	Some destinations (e.g. UAE, Qatar) as an intermediate step
Apostille	International certification under the Hague Convention	Between countries that are both Hague Convention members
WES/ECE Evaluation	Credential evaluation service	Often required for USA/Canada applications; takes 6-8 weeks

Step-by-Step Process

- ☐ Identify exactly which authentication method your destination and institution require
- ☐ Locate a certified translator or the relevant government authentication office
- ☐ Submit original documents (never send your only original by post without tracking)
- ☐ Allow 6-8 weeks for credential evaluation services (WES/ECE) specifically

- ☐ Keep both the authenticated copy and your original safe and separate

Start early

Credential evaluation and apostille processes are among the slowest steps in document preparation. Start this the moment you have your academic documents in hand - don't leave it until your visa deadline is close.